The *take-away*

Everything from the hackathon in one place: how to work with your AI, every step from warm-up to a live app, and every useful prompt and link. It's yours to keep.

Please read this first

This is a personal learning exercise. Use fictional or public sample content only. Do not enter, upload or share any LBG data in AI tools, GitHub repositories, prompts, screenshots or published websites. More on staying safe.

The latest copy is at hackday.bonhard.ai/talks/takeaway.pdf. Organised by Phil Bonhard. This guide does not claim endorsement by any organisation or approval of any tool.

Start here

How to use this

This is everything from the hackathon, written to be read on its own. You don't need the talks, and you can dip in anywhere.

Follow the five stops

The steps run in the same order as the My day board, from warm-up to a live app.

Copy the prompts

On the web page, each prompt has a Copy button. In the PDF, select the text. Change the words in [square brackets] to your own.

Read what comes back

A prompt is a starting point. Adjust the wording to your idea, then read and challenge what the AI gives you.

1. **Warm-up done**
   Hello world on your own computer
2. **GitHub connected**
   Your AI tool can save to your account
3. **Hello world pushed**
   Your page is on GitHub with a live address
4. **PRD shared**
   A short plan, reviewed and saved
5. **App live**
   Someone else can open it on their own device

Talk to it like a colleague

Think of your AI as a very fast colleague who's never met you. It knows a lot about building things and nothing about who you're designing for. That's your job.

You don't need special words. Brief it the way you'd brief a colleague. If the answer isn't right, say so. It won't be offended.

Ask it for help with anything, including "how do I...?"

- **Tell it who you are.** "I'm a designer. Explain things in plain words."
- **Give it context.** Who it's for, the problem, and what good looks like.
- **Keep talking.** Ask follow-up questions, and say "that's not what I meant".
- **Let it question you.** Ask it to ask you questions before it builds anything.

Show it, don’t describe it

A screenshot beats a paragraph. If something looks wrong, or you see an error you don’t understand, grab it, paste it and ask “what’s going on here?”

On a Mac

Grab part of the screen. Press `⌘ Cmd` `⇧ Shift` `4`, then drag a box round the bit you need.

Put it in the chat. Drag the thumbnail (bottom right) into the chat. Or add `Ctrl` to copy it, then press `⌘ Cmd` `V`.

On Windows

Grab part of the screen. Press `⊞ Win` `⇧ Shift` `S`, then drag a box round the bit you need.

Put it in the chat. It’s copied already. Click in the chat and press `Ctrl` `V`.

> **Grab only the bit you need.** A full-screen shot can catch Teams, email, notifications and other tabs. Share only a screenshot of your own sample product.

Stay in charge

AI can be confidently wrong. The cure is simple: small steps, and look at the result every time.

One change at a time

Ask, check, then the next thing.

Check it yourself

Open it, click it, try it on your phone. “Done” doesn’t always mean done.

Save when it works

Publish a working version before a big change.

If in doubt, ask it to explain its choices. “What were the options? Why this one?” That’s how you learn, and it’s often how you catch the mistake.

Going round in circles? Start a fresh chat and explain where you’ve got to.

Permissions, money and getting stuck

These tools can create files, run commands and use your accounts. That’s what makes them useful, and it’s why you read before you say yes.

Read before you say yes

Your AI asks permission before it does things. Say yes to your project folder and GitHub. Say no to anything you don’t understand, then ask for help.

Don’t buy anything on the spot

Asked to pay, upgrade or add a card without planning to? Stop and ask. Ran out of usage? Don’t top up in a panic.

The 10-minute rule

Stuck for ten minutes? Ask for help. Screenshot, paste, ask: your AI is the first helper you go to.

> **Never paste a password, key or token into a chat.** If your AI asks for one, say no. GitHub gives you a one-time code to type in yourself.

Choose your tool

Both do the same job. The warm-up takes about 25–35 minutes the first time (an estimate) and checks that your tools work. It's a rehearsal, not your product.

Claude

In the Claude desktop app's Code tab. Needs Claude Pro or higher, because Claude Code isn't on the free plan. Buying a plan is your choice.

Download the Claude app

Codex

In the ChatGPT desktop app. Listed on free and paid ChatGPT plans, with usage limits, so a paid plan gives you more room.

Download the ChatGPT app

> **Plans change.** Check the provider's own site before you sign up. Use your own personal accounts, not a work account or work email.

Make your first page

1. **Install the app and sign in.** In Claude, click the Code tab. In the ChatGPT app, choose Codex from the dropdown.
2. **Create a free GitHub account** at github.com/signup, with your own email. Your username is public. Remember how you signed up (email, Google or Apple) and always sign in the same way.
3. **Give it an empty folder.** Make a new folder called `hello-hackday` on your Desktop and open it in your tool.
4. **Ask for your page.** Paste this in. It may ask a question or two, or just make the page: either is fine. If it asks, answer in your own words, or say “you decide”.

   > I’d like you to create a webpage that simply says hello world.

5. **See it.** Ask “Please open the page in my browser”, or double-click the file ending in `.html`. The address starts with `file://`, which means it’s only on your computer.